

Illustration by SIDDHANT JUMDE

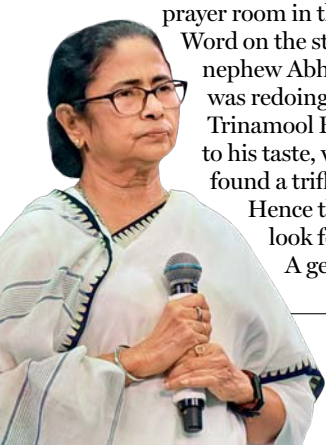
GLASSHOUSE

OLD GUARD, NEW BATTLES

On April 14, Prime Minister Narendra Modi inaugurated the Pradhanmantri Sangrahalaya—dedicated to all the 14 prime ministers of India—at the Teen Murti Estate in Delhi. Given that Teen Murti Estate was first Jawaharlal Nehru's home and, later, his memorial, the Congress was opposed to the museum, alleging that it was the BJP's way of undermining him. No one from the Gandhi family attended the inauguration; instead, the Congress released a video the next day celebrating PMs from the grand old party. To no one's surprise, P.V. Narasimha Rao, who goes largely unacknowledged by the Congress due to his bitter relationship with Sonia Gandhi, was missing in the video. Last year, a BJP attempt to embarrass the Congress by releasing a commemorative stamp on PVN's 100th birthday was scuttled after a leak before its official release. A stamp of disapproval?

Generation Gap

West Bengal chief minister **Mamata Banerjee's** new Trinamool office is all done. Though located on the same street as the old office, EM Bypass, it doesn't quite have the swank of the former. Apart from her room, Mamata also has a separate prayer room in the new office. Word on the street is that nephew Abhishek Banerjee was redoing the former Trinamool Bhawan according to his taste, which Mamata found a trifle flamboyant. Hence the decision to look for a new address. A generational gap?



FALLING IN LINE



Former Rajasthan chief minister **Vasundhara Raje** had, until recently, resisted showing her true saffron colours in public. However, on a visit to Karauli following the riots, she cried discrimination and asked the administration, "Is it a crime to be a Hindu here?" Raje also warned officials of stern action if she came to power. At another event, she recalled how she had spent Rs 550 crore on developing temples in Rajasthan and lauded PM Modi for building the Ram Mandir in Ayodhya. Seems like Raje is finally toeing the party line.



JUMPING THE GUN

On April 15, Bihar BJP chief **Sanjay Jaiswal** was among the last to arrive at Chief Minister **Nitish Kumar's** house for an Iftar party. But that is not all Jaiswal is late for. He is yet to placate Nitish after making a comment that Nitish will be CM only till 2025. It was construed as a signal from the BJP that it might be thinking ahead of the alliance. On April 16, the Rashtriya Janata Dal's drubbing of the BJP by over 36,000 votes in the Bochaha assembly bypoll made it clear that Jaiswal's assertions may well have alienated Nitish's voters.



Mirror Image

Outgoing army chief **Gen. Manoj Mukund Naravane** and his successor **Lt. Gen. Manoj Pande** have several things in common besides their first name. Both come from respected Maharashtrian families. Naravane's mother Sudha was a newsreader with the All India Radio in Pune, while Pande's mother Prema was an annoucer for the AIR in Nagpur. Both their siblings are in the armed forces, too. Talk about following the leader!

–Kaushik Deka with Rohit Parihar, Kiran D. Tare, Amitabh Srivastava and Romita Datta